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[00:15:00] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Sergeant in Arms. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:15:17] The House will rise and be led in prayer by the Honorable G. Paul Norto, Clerk of the House of Delegates Richmond, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Henry. Let us pray. Divine Source of all creation, we gather today in unity, representing diverse beliefs, backgrounds, and traditions.

[00:15:40] As the pace of the work of the Virginia House of Delegates picks up, may the members be guided by compassion, wisdom, and a commitment to justice for all. Grant them the strength to seek common good, the courage to embrace their differences, and the humility to serve with integrity.

[00:15:56] Amen. Amen. I have allegiance to the flag of the United States and to the republic, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:16:20] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:16:38] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I have examined and approved the Journal of the House of Delegates for Friday, January 23rd, 2026. Most of the

resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? Not at this time, Mr. Speaker.

[00:16:54] Therefore, in this first portion of the morning hour pursuant to House Rule 40, the speaker asks that you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed on reference on the voting board. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:17:10] I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that we pass by House Resolution 76, found on page 11 to Wednesday, January 28th. Without objection. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:17:26] I rise for the purpose of a motion, and I'd like to speak to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, many of us watched and stood on the tiptoes of anticipation yesterday as we watched the Seattle Seahawks advance to the Super Bowl as we watched them wear number 45 on their helmets.

[00:17:50] Number 45, Mr. Speaker, was a great athlete, a great person, a great leader from the South Norfolk section of Chesapeake, Kenneth Mason Easley.

[00:18:07] As a former athlete myself, Mr. Speaker, that played the game fiercely, I can truly say what an honor it was to every now and then see and be blessed by some persons who have the uncanny paradoxical heroes in the flesh they hold contradictions mr. speaker sometimes quiet yet powerful humble yet commanding gentle off the field but fierce in the moment ordinary

[00:18:45] and appearance extraordinary and impact heroes not fictional or mythic but people whose actions rise above the norm and inspire others on the field dashing records off the field driving the Sunday school bus led by an example in South Norfolk on the end off the court mr. speaker was the Oscar Smith UCLA Seahawks

[00:19:20] legend Kenneth Easley mr. speaker I could understand what Allen Iverson meant when he was talking about the time he described meeting Michael Jordan for the first time. For athletes growing up in South Norfolk, the truth is either you were aspiring to be like Kenny or you were lying. Mr. Speaker, that's why I believe we ought to honor him today

[00:19:56] in his memory because of the impact he had on the football and those who watched him play was both profound and enduring. Kenny Easley affectionately known as Poncho to the closest to him and revered by the fans everywhere as the enforcer.

[00:20:18] He was one of the most dominant defensive players ever to step onto the field. And as a safety for the Seattle Seahawks, he redefined excellence and his position, combining intelligence, thoughtfulness, toughness, leadership, and an uncompromising commitment to his teammates.

[00:20:38] A Pro Football Hall of Famer can easily earn Defensive Player of the Year honors and was widely respected not just for the athletic ability that he had, but for the way he played the game with discipline, heart, integrity, and as our Madam Governor said, dominance.

[00:20:59] He set a standard that continues to inspire generations of players long after the final whistle. Beyond the accolades, Kenny easily represented what it meant to lead by example.

[00:21:16] He was a teammate who's trusted an opponent and an opponent others respected and a figure whose legacy transcends sports itself. His memory reminds us of the true greatness is not measured only

by statistics and championships, but by character, impact, and the lives we touch along the way.

[00:21:42] Mr. Speaker, members of the House on November the 14th of last year, number 45 hung up his cleats for the last time on this side of the veil of tears.

[00:22:00] And Mr. Speaker, may we all watch the Super Bowl this year, remembering Kenny and remembering that in life, as he would once said, that if you just stay focused, keep your mind fixed, have faith and stay in the fight, you'll be fruitful.

[00:22:25] Mr. Speaker, because of his relentless grace and grit of this Virginia's son, I move that when the House adjourns, that it does so in the honor and memory of Kenneth Mason Easley Jr.

[00:22:43] The Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes, moves that when the House adjourns today, it does so in the honor and memory of Kenneth Mason Easley Jr. All those in favor shall rise. The motion is agreed to.

[00:23:01] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Creasy. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I stand for motion. The Delegate has the floor. I move that House Bill 368 on page 16 in the uncontested docket is re-referred to appropriations.

[00:23:18] Give us a little bit more time. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Prezik moves that House Bill 368 be re-referred back to the Committee on Appropriations. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to. House Bill 368 is re-referred.

[00:23:34] The delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Nicole Cole. Good morning, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move to pass by House Joint Resolution 55 on page 7 in the calendar to Thursday, January 29th.

[00:23:52] Thursday, January 29th, without objection. Call the next order of business. Mr. Speaker, the second portion of the morning hour, a member requests to move legislation from an uncontested calendar to the regular. On page 2 of the category, there are three bills in the category of uncontested.

[00:24:11] Second reading, bottom of page 2, the printed calendar of House Bill 1414 is taken out of the block and moved over to the regular calendar. That's the only one I'm aware of. Clerk will announce the next order. Third portion of the morning hour is a member request for legislation to go by for the day. And if such, the subsequent motion for about the majority leader, I'm not aware.

[00:24:31] We've done a couple already, but I'm not aware of any further ones. The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. We're good. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, if we could return to first morning hour. For what purpose? For a purpose to reconsider a motion to re-refer a bill back to committee.

[00:24:52] The wrong bill number was provided. Having voted on the prevailing side by which? Yes, Mr. Speaker. Having voted on the prevailing side on which we re-referred House Bill 368 to appropriations, I move that we reconsider that vote.

[00:25:12] The delegate from Alexandria, the delegate here, moves that we reconsider, Instead of having voted on the proponent side where we voted to take HB 368 back to appropriations, she wishes to reconsider that vote. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no.

[00:25:28] HB 368 is before us now. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I have another motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that House Bill 367 on page 16 be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations.

[00:25:44] And you want to keep 368 here? I want to leave 368 here and move 367 to the Committee on Appropriations. So the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Herring, moves that House B 368 stay on the first reading onto contested calendar, and House Bill 367 be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations.

[00:26:03] All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Clerk will announce the next order. And Mr. Speaker, the fourth and final portion of the morning hour is reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege.

[00:26:23] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I do not rise often in this chamber, but there are moments when silence is not an option, and today is one of those moments. One of the reasons I love working with you all is we are colleagues that have a diversity of viewpoints, a diversity of backgrounds, and that reminds me of another point in my life when I served and deployed in the United States Marine Corps with people from all walks of life that came together with different viewpoints, different even views about what

[00:26:56] America should be. But we came together not as partisans, but in service of a nation and in taking and in loyalty to an oath, not to a man, but to our constitution. So I rise today as a veteran, a lawful gun owner, a Virginian, and an American. Because what we witnessed over the weekend in Minneapolis and increasingly across the country is the opposite of public safety.

[00:27:25] And this is very personal for me because Minneapolis, like so many wonderful cities in our great nation, is the city that opened up its arms to my wife and her family when she immigrated and eventually became a citizen of the United States. And that city is in pain, Mr. Speaker, because let's be clear about what happened this past weekend.

[00:27:44] A lawful gun owner, properly carrying a concealed firearm, displaying no threatening intent. Recording law enforcement, as is his First Amendment right, was swarmed, thrown down, disarmed, and shot in the back.

[00:28:03] In a single moment, three constitutional rights were violated. The First Amendment, the right to record your government. The Second Amendment, the lawful possession of a firearm, according to the laws of your state. And the Fourth Amendment, freedom from unreasonable search and seizure.

[00:28:21] These actions in Minneapolis are not law enforcement. That is not accomplishing the mission of immigration enforcement. That is not making us safer, because I happen to know a little bit about keeping us safe, Mr. Speaker, because I know what right looks like. When my infantry battalion deployed to Afghanistan in 2012, we were trained relentlessly on the rules of engagement, escalation of force, and that accountability is paramount.

[00:28:46] And those principles allowed our unit to neutralize 70 Taliban insurgents, and this is the important part, without the loss of a single civilian life. Think about that. Six months of highly kinetic combat, not a single civilian life lost.

[00:29:05] Conversely, we look at what's happening now in our own nation where an untrained, unaccountable, militarized force operating outside of the rules of engagement with no knowledge of the escalation of force doctrines, freezing out local law enforcement, ignoring court orders and obstructing our own law enforcement investigations.

[00:29:23] This force has cost the lives of two Americans already, and it should alarm every Virginian, especially those who care deeply about the Second Amendment. Because here's the truth, Mr. Speaker. The government can seize a lawfully owned firearm without due process. They can shoot a citizen and then investigate the victim instead of the shooter. They can operate masked, unidentified, beyond accountability. Then there is no right that is secure. There is no first. There is no second. There is no fourth, not any. And the founding fathers warned us about this. They said that when the government fears the people,

[00:29:59] there is liberty. But when the people fear the government, there is tyranny. Mr. Speaker, these are not normal times. And this is a watershed moment in our shared American history. This moment is about whether we still believe that government answers the people, not the other way around. This is about making now, today, this week, this month, a time when we all push past the partisanship and declare loudly and clearly, these violations do not represent Virginia. These violations do not represent America.

[00:30:31] and now is the time for each of us to speak up and make our voices heard. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:30:49] Pursuant to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing bristle business on a granted leave from today's session, Delegates Knight and Whittle.

[00:31:05] Clerk will call the calendar. Ms. Speaker, calendar for today, Monday, January 22, 2026. First page of the printed calendar, first category. One piece of legislation in this, House Bill's on third reading regular calendar. House Bill 1384, which relates to impacts changes to Chapter 725, the Acts of Assembly of 2025, as well as providing for the submission of the voters of proposed amendments to the Constitution of Virginia, as well as repealing Section 30-13 of the Code of Virginia relating to the General Appropriation Act Department of Elections.

[00:31:36] Committee substitute rejected, a floor substitute was agreed to, and HB 1384 is now before you. Shall the bill pass?

[00:31:53] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, Noes 34. Ayes 62, Noes 34. The bill passes. Continuing with the calendar, new category, page two of the printed calendar, if you're following that way. House bills on second reading, uncontested calendar.

[00:32:08] Earlier, I verbally added an extra number, HB 414, not 1414, but House Bill 414 has been moved out of the block over to the regular calendar. So continuing, first bill in this block of two bills now is House Bill 175, which seeks to amend and reenact the code of Virginia relating to real property tax exemption.

[00:32:31] surviving spouses of members of the armed forces who died in the line of duty. This legislation report committee on finance. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Fagans. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 175 ensures that the surviving spouses of service members who died in the line of duty are not unintentionally burdened with real property taxes that voters intended them to be exempt from.

[00:32:51] After the 2024 constitutional amendment expanded eligibility to include line of duty deaths, existing assessed value caps created an unintentional consequence. Some surviving spouses in high-cost housing markets are now actually receiving tax bills despite meeting an eligibility requirements.

[00:33:07] In Virginia Beach alone, this affects 52 surviving spouses. HB 175 corrects that by allowing localities by ordinance to provide a full exemption regardless of excess value. It does not expand eligibility or mandate local adoption. It simply restores local flexibility so the exemption works as intended.

[00:33:29] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. The second bill in the uncontested block is House Bill 176, the legislation to amend and reenact several sections of the Code of Virginia relating to state-facilitated IRA savings programs. This legislation will report a committee on appropriations.

[00:33:44] The delegate for Prince William, delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 176 makes certain technical changes and broadens eligibility requirements for RetirePath, the state-facilitated retirement savings program administered by the Commonwealth Savers Plan. HB 176 will expand RetirePath eligibility in excess to more than 350,000 Virginia workers, allowing them a way to save for their retirement at no additional cost to the Commonwealth and our business community.

[00:34:14] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed this third reading. Shall the bills be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those deposed, no. The bills are engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing with today's calendar, page three, new category, House bills on second reading regular calendar.

[00:34:34] There are 1011 bills in this category, beginning with House Bill 38, which is legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia, relating to public schools, mental health awareness training, and instruction requirements. This legislation is the Board of Committee on Education. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Henson.

[00:34:50] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 38 strengthens Virginia's existing mental health awareness training requirements by requiring that all full-time teachers and other designated school personnel complete at least one mental health awareness training grounded in evidence-based practices with the focus on students a high risk of mental health challenges those students include students bereaved by suicide youth with mental or physical disabilities or chronic health conditions youth experiencing homelessness or housing instability youth and foster care or other forms of custodial instability and youth who identify as LGBTQIA plus

[00:35:27] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. House Bill 116 is legislation to amend and reenact sexual code of Virginia relating to school board employee grievance procedure, timing of dispute resolution.

[00:35:45] This legislation also reports a committee on education. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 116 says that all school staff, teacher assistants, school security, school secretaries, bus drivers, they all must get the same school board grievance process that teachers receive before facing any discipline action.

[00:36:08] This process works for teachers, and it'll work for everyone. I move that this bill be engrossed and sent on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? Are those in favor,

say aye. Are those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 171, legislation to amend and reenact, Texas Dakota, Virginia, relating to student instruction, internet safety, certain topics.

[00:36:31] This legislation also reports the Committee on Education. Delic from Virginia Beach, I'll let you ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, families across the Commonwealth know that kids spend hours online every day. HB 171 strengthen school internet safety policies to cover the real digital threats they face. The bill seeks to amend and update the required internet safety instructions in every school division and ensures age-appropriate lessons to tackle modern risks head-on.

[00:36:55] The current rules cover basics, but kids encounter new dangers like addictive algorithms, cyberbullying, AI-generated harms. HB 171 mandates schools include these key topics so kids learn and navigate safely. I'm going to speak our move that this bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading.

[00:37:10] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Top of page four, continuing House bills on second reading regular. House Bill 199 is legislation to amend and reenact. Portion of the acts of assembly of 2024 relating to the Board of Education through year growth assessment system alternatives during the 2024-25 through 2027-28 school years.

[00:37:36] This legislation report committing on education. Senator from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, House Bill 199 extends out for a couple more years local assessments as we are negotiating the longer term assessment contracts. This gives some more flexibility to the localities to better adapt to some of the changing needs of the students.

[00:37:56] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? Are those in favor, say aye. Are those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 206. This legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia land to college partnerships, laboratory schools.

[00:38:13] Transparency. Legislation reported for Kennedy on education. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gumar. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. House Bill 206 seeks to ensure transparency and accountability in the administration of our lab schools.

[00:38:29] Currently, lab schools are K-12 public schools that may be offered through a third party. While lab schools can offer diversity of opportunity, it is important that parents and custodians understand who governs the schools and who to contact should they have a concern.

[00:38:47] That's why this bill makes sure parents are given contact information to get an audience to address concerns about their children. This bill also provides governing, budget, and policy information so that parents and custodians have the information necessary to determine what is best for their child.

[00:39:07] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 210 is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to school meal debt annual report.

[00:39:24] This legislation was reported from the Committee on Education as well. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 210 comes from the Virginia Commission to

end hunger's recommendations. As we were discussing possible solutions to school nutrition issues, we found that there are families that do not quite qualify for free or reduced lunch, but still are having trouble affording school meals for their children.

[00:39:50] We know there are millions of dollars in school meal debt, but we do not have an accurate picture for the total amount for the Commonwealth or how big of a problem this may be. This bill would help with that by getting data. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading?

[00:40:07] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Top of page 5 of the printed calendar, continuing House Bill's second reading regular, House Bill 282, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact Portions of Dakota, Virginia, related to real property tax, classification of land and improvements, Charlottesville and Falls Church.

[00:40:25] Legislation report a committee on finance with an amendment in nature of substitutes. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt a committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:40:41] Speaking to the bill, House Bill 282 allows the cities of Charlottesville, Falls Church, Newport News, and Fredericksburg the ability to set tax rates for land separately from improvements. At a time when Virginia is facing a housing shortage, this bill allows these cities to find market-friendly, local solutions to the growing housing crisis in Virginia, a crisis defined by a lack of supply.

[00:41:04] It also allows them to reduce homeowner taxes at the same time. With that, I ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Mr. Speaker, parliamentary inquiry. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, would House Bill 282 be special?

[00:41:20] Legislation require two-thirds vote? I think so, but House will be at ease. 80 votes, I mean, sorry.

[00:41:40] From Scott County, Delegate Kilgore, that legislation is special legislation, not emergency legislation, requires a two-third vote, 67 votes.

[00:42:09] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossing past the third read. Continuing with the calendar, House Bill 288. House Bill 288 requires the Department of Education to post certain instructional resources on its website.

[00:42:26] This legislation will report committee on education. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 288 is an opportunity to expand access to Virginia's history on the Virginia Department of Education's website with the assistance of the Virginia Tribal Education Consortium, or VTEC, a non-profit formed in 2019 by the seven federally recognized tribes here in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[00:42:54] HB 288 will simply allow VTEC to have a placeholder on the VDOE's website, of which they will be responsible for maintaining the information and curriculum and ensuring that the information remains current and accurate. Finally, this bill will improve VDOE's website by providing a greater public access to much needed educational resources about our tribes.

[00:43:13] With that, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, would the delegate yield for a question? Would the delegate yield? Yes, I would yield for a question. The delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate, it sounds to me like the goal of this legislation is to attract eyeballs to a website, right, and to do that.

[00:43:34] And I would ask the delegate if she feels like she has some expertise in that, and to sort of demonstrate her expertise, if she could tell us all how many Instagram followers she has on her Instagram page. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I can speak to that question.

[00:43:51] I have 74,000 followers on Instagram. I can definitely help make sure that people get eyeballs on important pieces of information on websites. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for an additional question? Will the delegate yield to brag about our Instagram? Yes, I will yield for an additional question.

[00:44:08] Mr. Speaker, I noticed that the delegate described the Virginia Tribal Education Consortium. I wonder if she could tell us the names and maybe pronounce for us the names of the seven tribes that make up the Virginia Tribal Educational Consortium. Yes, Mr. Speaker. So, the seven tribes are the Chickahominy Indian Tribe, the Chickahominy Indian Tribe Eastern Division, the Manukone Indian Tribe, the Nansumand Indian Tribe, the Pamunkey Indian Tribe, the Rappahannock Tribe, and the Upper Mattapanai Indian Tribe.

[00:44:40] Mr. Speaker, Mr. Speaker, I thank the delegate. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[00:44:57] Next up on the category, House Bill 334, legislation that seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia related to additional local sales and use tax to support schools' referendum. Legislation report a committee on finance. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul.

[00:45:13] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, House Bill 334 finally allows us to, instead of building on the Christmas tree of localities that come back year after year, to ask for this permissive authority takes it statewide, and with the statewide authority now, all localities will be able to put a referendum up to determine if their locality would like to have this additional measure to provide capital needs for their schools. Two extra things to keep

[00:45:45] in mind, this does allow for towns to be included, and also as we move forward, this allows for these provisions to apply to schools that have been constructed in the past as well and they're servicing with current debt. I hope it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading. Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Falkia County, Delegate Weber. Apologies, Mr. Speaker. Would the delegate yield for a question? Would the delegate yield? I yield, Mr. Speaker. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So in regards to, I would ask the gentleman, Mr. Speaker,

[00:46:22] In regards to the funds where it could go back and take care of previously built schools, does that then take away kind of the sunset that was in the provision before, where those taxes had to be for a very specific project, and then it just kind of went away?

[00:46:40] Delegate from Wild Oak City. Mr. Speaker, I'd answer the gentleman by delineating two things here. So for localities that had this provision in place themselves, they would continue through the date certain that was provided in their previous referendum.

[00:46:58] Should they want to continue on, they would have to have a new referendum. The provision that I was referring to, Mr. Speaker, would be any additional debt that they had taken on separate from the provision in law that had already been set in place. I thank the gentleman.

[00:47:15] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third of the reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is grossed and passed the third reading. Turning to page six, if you're following that way, House Bill 341, legislation to bend and reenact, such as Dakota, Virginia, relating to plastic bag tax distribution to towns.

[00:47:33] This legislation also is reported from the Committee on Finance. Delegate from Loudon, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 341 requires that any town located within a county that has imposed a disposable plastic tax receive a distribution of those revenues collected by the county based on the local sales tax distribution formula for appropriations to towns.

[00:47:59] This bill does not create a tax, but ensures that towns are able to use these funds that are generated within the town. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading?

[00:48:16] All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. Mr. Speaker, returning to page 2, picking up House Bill 414, which was moved from the uncontestable regular calendar. This bill is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to selective service to your college transfer grant, Virginia Tuition Assistance Grant Program, the Legislation Report Committee on Appropriations.

[00:48:41] From Prince William, Delegate Guzman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 414 put us in alignment with the federal regulations. What this bill does is ensure that every college student who applies for FAFSA is eligible for state grants such as the Virginia Tuition Assistance Grant.

[00:48:58] This bill will lower barriers to higher education, save students money, and keep Virginia among the best states for higher education. Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill is engrossed and passed on to its third reading. All those in favor say aye. I'm sorry, shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[00:49:16] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. the building goes to pass the third reading. Continuing with today's calendar, new category of page six of the printed calendar, memorial resolutions laid on the speaker's table. The memorial resolutions to be adopted in block are listed on pages six and seven, with the exception of House Joint Resolution 55, which is by until Thursday. All those in favor of adopting the memorial resolutions laid on the speaker's table, as listed on pages six through seven of the

[00:49:46] calendar shall rise. The resolutions are agreed to. And finally, page 8 of the printed calendar, next category, final category, commending resolutions laid on the speaker's table.

[00:50:03] Commending resolutions to be adopted in block are listed on pages 8 through 12, with the exception pulled out of the block of House Joint Resolution 11 and 13, as well as House Joint Resolution 76, which is by until Wednesday. Everything else remains in the block.

[00:50:22] All those in favor of adopting the commending resolutions laid on the Speaker's table found on pages 8 through 12, with the exception of those listed by the Clerk of the Pliny Calendar, will say aye.

Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, that completes today's calendar. Per House Rule 51, the House is returned to the morning hour.

[00:50:45] Does the Clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communications announcements, simply the meeting schedule, which has been modified somewhat. Immediately upon adjournment of the House, the Finance Subcommittee No. 1 will be meeting in House Committee Room B.

[00:51:03] That is immediately upon adjournment on the second floor, House Committee Room B. Then once that subcommittee is finished, then the Courts of Justice Criminal Subcommittee will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the Finance Subcommittee.

[00:51:19] They'll be next door in House Room C on the second floor. Also, 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House, roughly 1 o'clock-ish, the Courts of Justice Civil Subcommittee. They'll be meeting in the House North Subcommittee Room, also on the second floor. Appropriations and any of its subcommittees are not meeting today.

[00:51:40] So then looking ahead a little bit further later in the afternoon, at 4 o'clock, the Committee on Agriculture, Chesapeake and Natural Resources, their Chesapeake Subcommittee, will be meeting at 4 o'clock in House Committee Room A. That will be down at the lower level, of course. Also at 4 o'clock, Privileges and Elections Committee.

[00:51:57] The Elections Administration Subcommittee will be meeting. They'll be in the House South Subcommittee Room on the second floor. And then finally, the Northern Virginia Delegation Caucus will be meeting at 5 o'clock. They'll be in the House Subcommittee Room 10, 10th floor meeting room on the 10th floor of the GAB.

[00:52:14] Looking ahead to tomorrow, Tuesday, the 27th of January, bright and early. privileges and elections full committees campaigns and candidates subcommittee will meet at 7 a.m. they'll be in the north subcommittee room on the second floor at 730 the conservative caucus will be meeting they'll be on the eighth floor subcommittee room also at 730 the education education committees k-12 subcommittee will be meeting in the house committee room on the lower level. The Committee on Transportation's Department of Motor Vehicles subcommittee

[00:52:51] is meeting at 8 o'clock on Tuesday. They'll be in House Committee Room B on the second floor. Transportation is foregoing. The full committee is foregoing that, so you'll have that subcommittee. And then once that subcommittee, DMV sub, is finished, then the Transportation Committee's Transportation Infrastructure and Funding subcommittee will be in House Room B at 8.30 committee on health and human services will be meeting there in house committee room c on the second floor then once the full committee's finished the hhs health subcommittee will be meeting and then finally the democratic caucus will meet at 11 15 tomorrow and the republican

[00:53:31] caucus will meet at 11 30 both of them will be meeting at 11 15 democrats in house room one republicans in house room two and finally the pages will be returning uh tomorrow so um we appreciate you all rolling with us today with the weather and everything else. So that's all the answer I have, sir. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate rises for a motion to return to the fourth morning hour. Yes, sir, Mr. Speaker. I would ask for permission to return to the fourth morning hour such that I might rise for a point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Thank you,

[00:54:05] Mr. Speaker. I love Kenny Easley. I did. He was awesome. But that's not why I rise. I want to sort of speak to a timeline, and it's an American timeline. In 1787, the Constitution of the United States was signed. In 1788, it was ratified. Fast forward to 1971, and the Virginia Constitution was signed and ratified by this body. Fast forward to 2020, Mr. Speaker, and 99 out of 100 House districts told us resoundingly to take partisanship out of redistricting. But if you fast forward to

[00:54:38] October of 2025, golly, Ned, the Crime Commission met, and they recommended that we remove provisions that were enacted in 1971. And even the minority leader in the Senate was hoodwinked into saying, yeah, that's a good idea, but I'm not excited about that. Senator Lucas hoodwinks him three times a week.

[00:54:55] That's not that big a deal. The next week, they told us that they were going to redraw the districts. And they couldn't do that unless they could go back in time. So Marty McFly, Mr. Speaker, would be proud. It's like a back-to-the-future moment, because last week, the Senate of Virginia lurched back into time and retroactively revoked provisions of the law 30-13, such that we could do what we want to do right now.

[00:55:23] And today, on House Bill 1334, the House took a step towards doing that same thing. Wow. So imagine this, Mr. Speaker, January 2026, we've invented a time machine. We can go back 55 years and retroactively change the law, because suddenly it's inconvenient.

[00:55:42] What else could we do? January 27th, 1991, Super Bowl XXV, that's XXV to those of you in Rome. The New York Giants lead the Buffalo Bills with eight seconds to go in the game. And Virginian and JMU alum Scott Norwood strides onto the field with an opportunity to kick the field goal and win the game 22-20.

[00:56:03] But Mr. Speaker, it didn't happen. In fact, if you're a Buffalo Bills fan, you'll remember, wide right, wide right. But wait, what if the Bills had Virginia Democrats' support? I can hear the language now. Notwithstanding any NFL rules to the contrary, the goalposts for the final Bills drive shall be retroactively moved five yards to the right.

[00:56:25] Bills win. Virginian and NFL Hall of Famer Bruce Smith is a Super Bowl champion. Oh, wow, this is awesome. And then we'd say, well, how'd you do it? And they'd say, well, we only did it because Bill Parcells made more points in the first 59 minutes and 52 seconds than we did, and so we had to do it.

[00:56:42] And then they'd say, but we're just doing it this one time, and after this, we'll move the goalpost right back to where everybody said they wanted him. It's amazing. Mr. Speaker, Virginia Democrats are turning the Constitution of Virginia into the legislative equivalent of a grade-school pinky promise.

[00:57:01] It's as if you violated your most sacred vows and then told the one to whom you made that sacred commitment, "It's somebody else's fault. I had to do it. But don't worry. I promise I won't do it again." Mr. Speaker, we got to stop gaslighting the Virginians.

[00:57:16] People know what they wanted. People know what they asked for. People know what they voted for. and they're not stupid, contrary to what 60-some-odd people in this room might think. I want to carry a bill that says make ex-past post-facto laws illegal again, but I'm afraid that since it sounds like some other stuff, people in this room would have a temper tantrum, we'd have to shut the building down.

[00:57:34] Mr. Speaker, I never thought I'd live to see the moment that we invented a time machine, but surely if we have one, there are more important things that we could correct than changing laws 55 years hence because you don't like them. But that's what it's come to, Mr. Speaker. I'm beside myself. I'm mind-blown. I'm gobsmacked.

[00:57:52] I'm awestruck, I'm disappointed, but sadly, Mr. Speaker, I'm not surprised. I'll yield. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:58:11] Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn.

[00:58:27] The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that the House do now adjourn. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to. The house is adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.

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